

Transferring a sketch

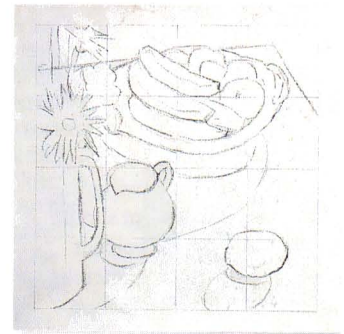
Once you have selected the most interesting composition, the best way of transferring it to a canvas or a board is to use a grid system (see also below right). Place a grid over the original sketch and draw a similar grid on a larger scale on the support. Transfer details from each square on the sketch using charcoal (below), or drawing directly with a brush and a thin mix of paint (right). Pencil can be used very faintly, but it is generally not recommended as it can soil the color of the paint. Some artists like to fill the outlines of shapes with light cross-hatching to determine areas of tone.



If you draw directly with a brush, use a thin mix of paint in a light or neutral color so that it does not show through the painting.

Drawing grid

Draw a grid of squares onto a piece of tracing paper or acetate and then place it over the original sketch. This may seem like a laborious process for transferring an image, but it is a useful way to make sure the proportions of the composition remain intact.



Drawing grid



Doughy bread

Dusting off

If you draw with charcoal, use a large soft brush or a piece of doughy bread to dust the charcoal off and leave the residual image as a guide. Another option is to seal the charcoal with a fixative.

